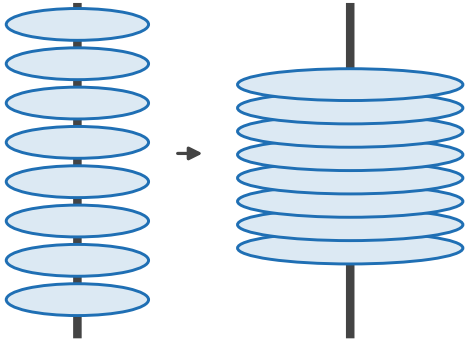
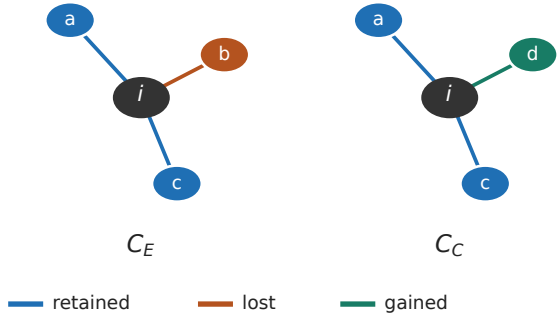
From sheath contraction to a site-level evolutionary test

a Contraction of an assembled sheath



Illustrative geometry; not to scale

b Contact identity can change at equal count



3 contacts per state; 2 shared; 4 in the union

$R_i = 1 - |C_E \cap C_C| / |C_E \cup C_C| = 0.5$

c Structural comparison and evolutionary correspondence

Contact example is hypothetical; no energies or transition trajectories are inferred.